

LINTEL NY · 2026 EDITION

2026 NYC Renovation Cost Guide

Room-by-room cost breakdowns, borough comparisons, what moves the price, and red flags to avoid.

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How to Use This Guide

These ranges reflect 2026 market conditions for licensed, permitted, fully insured renovation work in New York City and Long Island. They assume qualified subcontractors, all applicable permits, and Lintel NY's documentation standard — written contract, detailed scope, and signed change orders throughout.

A written estimate requires an on-site assessment. These ranges are for planning purposes — they help you understand the scope of investment before your first contractor conversation.

01 — Bathroom Renovation

Cost Ranges — NYC Metro 2026

Scope	Low	High	Typical Duration
Cosmetic Refresh (tile paint, fixtures, accessories)	\$9,000	\$18,000	1–3 weeks
Full Gut — Standard (ALT2, new tile, fixtures, plumbing)	\$18,000	\$38,000	3–5 weeks
Full Gut — Mid-Range (stone tile, custom vanity, glass)	\$35,000	\$60,000	4–7 weeks
Full Gut — Luxury (imported tile, heated floor, steam)	\$58,000	\$90,000+	6–10 weeks

What Moves the Price

Manhattan adds 15–20% to Brooklyn-equivalent scopes. Co-op board requirements (alteration deposits, superintendent inspections, neighbor notification) add \$4,000–\$10,000 in soft costs and 4–8 weeks to the timeline. Wet-over-dry conditions (bathroom above a living space) require additional waterproofing documentation. Relocating the drain stack to a different wall can add \$3,500–\$8,000.

Non-Negotiables at Lintel NY

Schluter KERDI waterproofing membrane on all wet surfaces — flood-tested 24 hours before tile. Floor tile DCOF rating ≥ 0.42. All wiring in EMT metallic conduit (NYC code). Licensed master plumber on every project. DOB permit filed before demo begins.

02 — Kitchen Remodeling

Cost Ranges — NYC Metro 2026

Scope / Location	Low	High	Duration
Brooklyn — Mid-Range	\$48,000	\$105,000	6–10 wks
Manhattan — Mid-Range	\$58,000	\$128,000	7–12 wks
Nassau County — Mid-Range	\$48,000	\$108,000	6–10 wks
High-End (custom cabs, stone, appliances)	\$80,000	\$165,000+	10–16 wks

The Five Cost Buckets

Cabinetry (30–40% of total)	Semi-custom: \$6,500–\$15,000 for a full set. Stock cabinets: rental-grade only. Custom: \$20,000+ for non-standard layouts.
Countertops (15–25%)	Quartz: \$55–\$90/sq ft installed. Calacatta marble: \$90–\$200/sq ft. Fabrication lead time: 10–14 business days after cabinet install — this is on the critical path.
Plumbing (8–15%)	Moving the sink adds significant cost — requires floor penetration or drop ceiling routing. DOB ALT2 permit required for all plumbing changes.

Electrical (8–15%)

Dedicated 20A circuits for dishwasher and microwave, GFCI counter circuits, under-cabinet lighting. All EMT conduit in NYC.

Finishes & Labor (20–30%)

Backsplash tile, flooring, painting, appliance reconnection, lighting installation.

03 — Co-op & Condo Renovation

Scope	Low	High	Duration
1BR Co-op — Bathroom Only	\$22,000	\$65,000	6–12 wks incl. board
2BR Co-op — Kitchen + Bath	\$85,000	\$180,000	10–20 wks
Full Gut Co-op Renovation	\$100,000	\$200,000+	12–24 wks
Condo (faster approval)	\$80,000	\$180,000	10–18 wks

The co-op premium is not in the construction cost — it's in the time and soft costs. Board approval adds \$4,000–\$10,000 in soft costs (deposits, professional fees, neighbor notification) and 4–12 weeks to the project timeline. We file DOB permits in parallel with board review — saving 2–4 weeks compared to filing after approval.

04 — Brownstone & Full Home Renovation

Scope	Low	High	Duration
1–2 Floor Renovation (not full gut)	\$150,000	\$280,000	12–20 wks
Full Brownstone Gut (3–4 stories)	\$350,000	\$650,000	20–36 wks
Landmark District (LPC required)	\$400,000	\$700,000+	24–40 wks

05 — 10 Red Flags in Contractor Quotes

Use this checklist when evaluating any contractor proposal.

1	No written scope of work A lump-sum quote with no line items means you cannot verify what is and is not included. Any dispute becomes a he-said-she-said.
2	No permit mentioned Any plumbing or electrical work in NYC requires DOB permits. A quote that doesn't mention permits either excludes them or plans to skip them.
3	Verbal change order process If a contractor says 'we'll work it out as we go,' that is the setup for a project that runs 40% over budget.
4	Unusually low price Below-market pricing means either unlicensed labor, no permits, inferior materials, or all three. The savings evaporate at closing.
5	No insurance certificate A contractor without current GL insurance working in your apartment means you are personally liable for any injury or damage.
6	Payment due in full upfront A reputable contractor does not need 100% payment before starting. Standard structure: deposit, milestone payments, final on punch list sign-off.
7	No licensed master plumber or electrician NYC law requires a licensed master plumber to file and supervise all plumbing work. The same applies to electrical. This is not optional.
8	No timeline in writing A project without a written timeline has no accountability. Duration directly affects your disruption and any penalties for late completion.
9	Alteration agreement not reviewed A contractor who hasn't read your building's alteration agreement cannot accurately price co-op work and will hit surprises that cost you money.
10	Can't provide DOB permit history A contractor who regularly pulls permits can provide examples. A contractor who avoids them cannot. Ask to see two recent permit numbers.

About Lintel NY

Lintel NY is a licensed NYC Home Improvement Contractor (HIC #2109847-DCA) and EPA Lead-Safe Certified Firm serving all five NYC boroughs and Long Island. Every project is delivered with a written contract, detailed scope of work, all applicable permits, and a formal punch list sign-off. Contact us: (212) 347-2111 · info@lintelny.com · lintelny.com